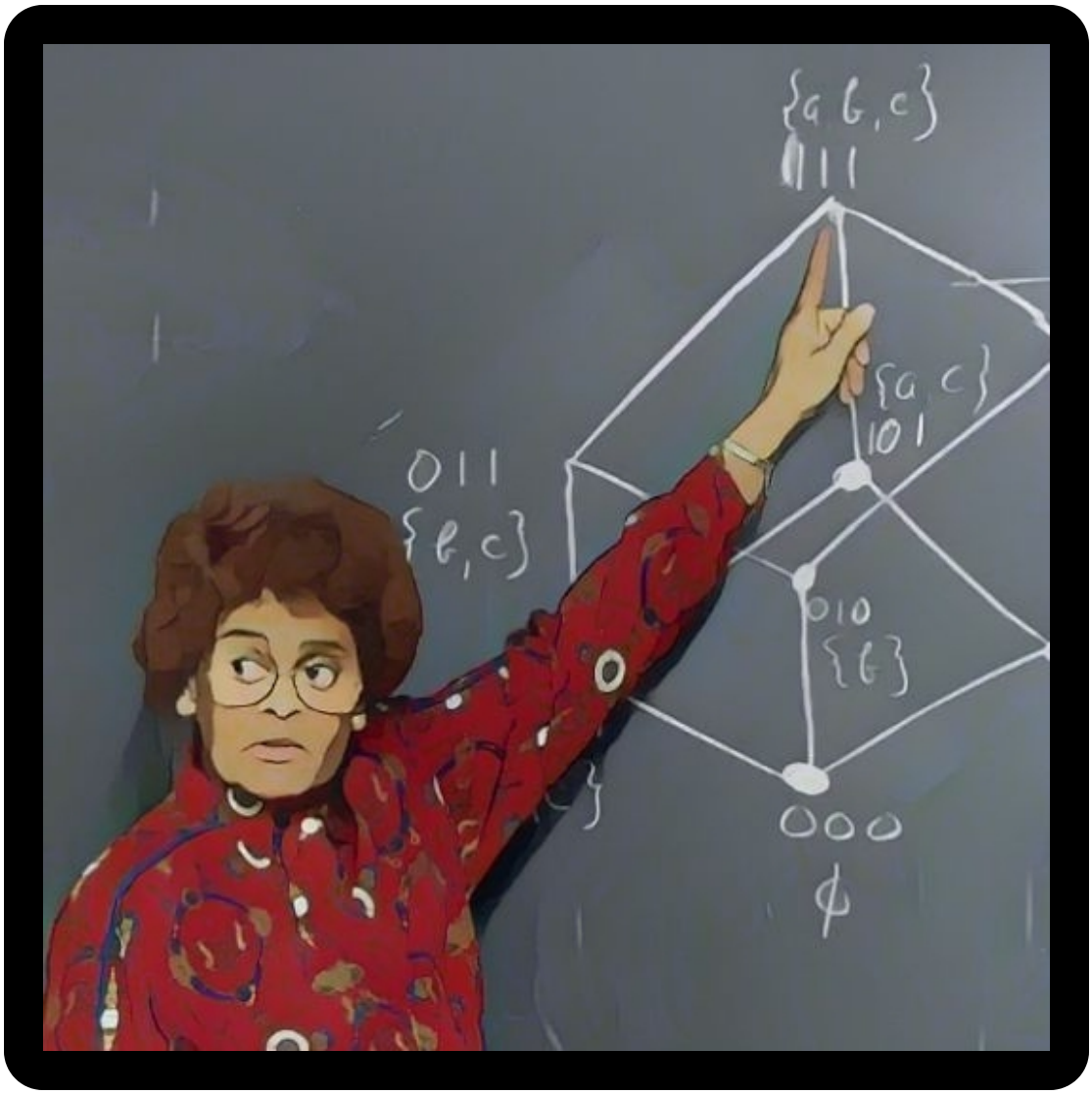

Evelyn Granville image, in the Marketing & Communications Records, The University Archives & Special Collections Department, Robert R. Muntz Library, The University of Texas at Tyler, Tyler, TX, USA, cartoonized using vanceai.com

EVELYN GRANVILLE

MATHEMATICIAN, COMPUTER SCIENTIST, EDUCATOR

As only the second African-American woman to receive an advanced degree in math from an American University (PhD from Yale in 1949), Granville started her career teaching at Fisk University (a highly rated Historically Black University in Nashville). She went on to work for NASA, writing computer programs that tracked the paths of vehicles in space. In reflecting on her childhood, Granville recounts, "We heard about and read about individuals whose achievements were contributing to the good of all people. These individuals, men and women, served as our role models; we looked up to them and we set our goals to be like them. We accepted education as the means to rise above the limitations that a prejudiced society endeavored to place upon us."

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